What is Plan Segmentation?

In the Workforce Planning (WFP) context, Plan segmentation refers to the systematic allocation of organizational resources, specifically headcount and associated costs, into structured plans that enable effective workforce management.

For a Business leader, Plan segmentation outlines the span of ownership over the users that the leader is responsible for planning. It also provides an overview of their OpEx targets for the next year.

For a Finance partner, Plan segmentation is useful for reviewing the span of ownership and setting targets.

Overview

Plan segmentation establishes a framework where each leader maintains a unique plan that operates independently of cost center ownership constraints. This ensures comprehensive coverage of all reporting headcount while maintaining data integrity through a single source of truth.

Features

Workforce Planning home

Leaders access WFP from the landing page (Workforce Planning home), which allows them to get an overview of their planning scope. The landing page interface displays total reports-to headcount along with cost center distribution information split by fixed and variable cost centers, allowing leaders to view headcount data, and examine distribution patterns (by organizational leader (OL) 5 leaders and fixed/variable cost centers). The navigation and drill-down capabilities enable leaders to analyze specific segments (baseline OpEx, headcount, targets, and initiatives) of their workforce.

OL5 target visibility

The system displays targets broken down by OL5 leaders under an OL4 org, with all target data sourced directly from respective OL4's primary finance partners. Finance partners use an interface within WFP to input and manage the targets.

Segments

Segments divide the organization of the leader into distinct services, projects, or teams, where each segment operates with its own workforce plan complete with specific operational expenditures (OpEx) targets, enabling targeted strategies at any organizational level.

Users

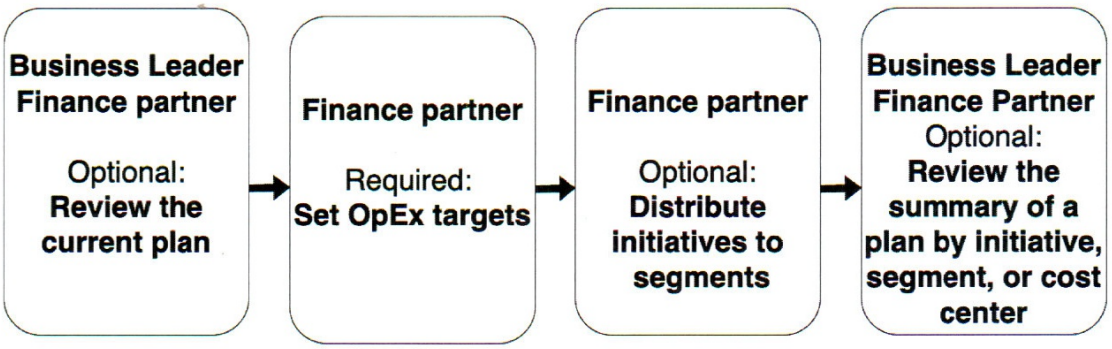
- **Finance partner**: typically an OL4 or OL5
- **Business leader**: OL4 or OL5

Get Started with Plan segmentation

Prerequisites

Access to WFP either as a Finance partner (OL4 or OL5) or Business leader (OL4 or OL5).

Workflow



Tasks

- Business leader and Finance partner: **Optional**: Review the current plan
- Finance partner only: **Required**: Set OpEx targets
- Finance partner only: **Optional**: Distribute initiatives to segments
- Business leader and Finance partner: **Optional**: Review the summary of a plan by initiative, segment, or cost center

Review the current plan

Optional: Business leader and Finance partner

The WFP home pages are different, depending on the user:

Business leader (OL4 or OL5)

a) In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
A page opens with a top heading:
Workforce planning
Your workforce plans

b) To select a plan: click **View population** next to the specific <*Planning cycle*> <*Owner name*> workforce plan you want to view. **Example**: 2026 OP2 <*Owner name*>.
The Plan page opens:
Workforce planning <Owner name> workforce plans
<*Owner name*> <*Planning cycle*>

Finance partner

a) In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
A leader page opens:
Workforce planning <*Owner name*> workforce plans
<*Owner name*> <*Planning cycle*>. **Example**: <*Owner name*> 2026 OP2.

1. Review the current plan. The areas to review include:
    a. **Operating expenses**
    Baseline OpEx | OpEx Target
    b. **Plan segmentation** (based on the reporting structure of your org)
    Direct reports | Start-of-plan BIS | Baseline OpEx | Reduction/Growth | OpEx Target | End-of-plan HC target

Note: If there is an issue with a plan not displaying correctly, you can submit a ticket for help: Create an issue

Set OpEx targets

Required: Finance partner only

Finance partners must set the initial OpEx targets for the OP 2 <*Year*> planning cycle. **Example**: OP2 2026. No past (historical) plan segmentations exist.

Steps:

1. In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
   A leader page opens:
   Workforce planning <*Owner name*> workforce plans
   <*Owner name*> <*Planning cycle*>. **Example**: <*Owner name*> 2026 OP2.
2. In the upper-right corner of the plan page, click **Add targets**.
   The Edit workforce planning targets page opens.
3. In the Baseline information area, select a **Planning cycle** (example: 2026 OP2) and a **Business leader**.
4. Below the Business leader dropdown, click **Add initiative**.
   The Baseline OpEx and OpEx target areas display.
5. Below the heading for BaselineOpEx, for the first dropdown, select either: **Investment** or **Reduction**.
6. For the next dropdown (to the right of the one above in step 5), select what type of cost center the Investment or reduction applies to: either **Fixed**, **Variable**, or both **(Fixed & Variable)**.
7. For the third dropdown from the left, select a category for a type of initiative: **Add or extend a service**, **AI efficiency initiative**, **Other efficiency initiative**, **Reduce a service**, **Net adjustment**.
8. For the fourth dropdown from the left, select if the input is a percent or integer: **Percent adjustment** (default) or **Fixed amount**.
9. For the text box (the last box in the row), type a value.
   The input is automatically distributed down through the segments.
10. **Optional**: After adding targets is complete, you can add an Effective date for when to schedule the release of the OpEx targets.
    In the schedule the release of this target (optional) area, select an **Effective date**, **Effective start time**, and **Timezone**.
11. Click **Save Targets**.

Distribute initiatives to segments

Optional: Finance partner only

You can add (distribute) initiatives to a segment(s) and then make any necessary adjustment(s).

Note: Start this task *after* you complete steps 1-9 of Set OpEx targets.

1. Enable (slide to the right) the **Distribute initiatives to segments based on baseline operating expenses** button.
   Below the button, a dropdown displays for selecting a <*Plan owner*>.
2. For the dropdown below the button in step 1, select a <*Plan owner*>.
3. Click **Add initiative**.
   A new line of boxes opens for making adjustments to a segment.
4. Make any necessary changes to the line of dropdowns and input box.
5. If necessary, to make adjustments to more segments. Click **Add initiative** and make changes to the new line of boxes that opens.
6. If necessary, enable (move to the right) the **Enable override** button.
   The BIS override input box displays.
7. Type a number in the **BIS override** input box.

Review the summary of a plan by initiative, segment, or cost center

Optional: Business leader and Finance partner

There are several ways to understand and contextualize the plan segmentation information. After Set OpEx targets is complete, you can review the summary of a plan by initiative, segment, or cost center.

1. In Amazon A to Z, navigate to Workforce Planning home.
   The page with this heading opens:
   Workforce planning
   Your workforce plans
   There is a list of <*Planning cycle*> workforce plans. Example: 2026 OP2.
2. To select a plan: click **View population** next to the specific <*Planning cycle*> <*Owner name*> workforce plan you want to view. **Example**: 2026 OP2 <*Owner name*>
   The Plan page opens:
   Workforce planning <*Owner name*> workforce plans
   <*Owner name*> <*Planning cycle*>
   In the Plan segmentation area of the page, there is a **View summary** (default) dropdown box.

3. From the same dropdown, select a desired summary of a plan by **initiative**, **segment**, or **cost center**.
    - **Initiative**
      Displays figures for each initiative. **Examples**: Reductions: AI Innovation. Reductions: Service retirement.
    - **Segment**
      Displays cost center and Start-of-plan BIS by each segment using a reports to hierarchy.
    - **cost center**
      Displays separate figures (BIS owner, <*Year*> Start BIS...) for each cost center.

Next steps

For a Plan owner, the next step is to start the <*Planning cycle*> planning process with Plan Builder. **Example**: 2026 OP2. Navigate to: **Get started with Plan Builder** [Add a link]

Note: After a Business leader publishes a Plan of Record, a Finance partner can validate the published plan CSVs.